



Wi-Fi Connect Your PDA And PC

Wouldn't you like to transfer data from your pocket PC to your laptop or desktop PC? Read on to learn how to do just that using Wi-Fi...

Varun Dubey

Have you ever had your cell phone stolen? Or lost? If you have a PDA phone, then the loss of a cell phone doesn't just imply loss of mere contact numbers but also the incalculable loss of important office files and business e-mails.

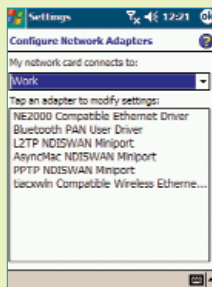
Let's think of a less heart-wrenching but equally exasperating scenario. Consider that you would like to perform a seamless transfer of files between your PC and your PDA or you would like to take a backup. Here's a step-by-step process through which you will be able to link your PDA to your laptop or computer using a Wi-Fi connection.

1 Startup

Start your handheld PC, and go to **Start > Connections > Settings > Network Cards**.

2 Check Connection Capabilities

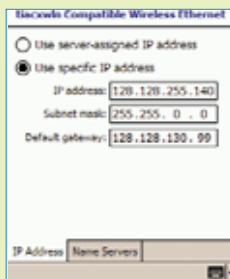
Here, you will see all the connection capabilities of your device. It will list your Wi-Fi cards, Bluetooth adapter and other connectivity devices. Click the drop-down menu and select 'Work'. Select your Wireless Ethernet card from the list of the various cards given.



Selecting the Network adapter

3 Network Settings For The Phone

Next, the settings page for the card appears. Here, click 'Use Specific IP address'. Remember, the IP address should be of the same series as that on your PC or laptop. Essentially, this means if your laptop has the IP address 128.128.130.140, Enter the IP address



Enter the IP address

your PDA or Pocket PC must have an IP address beginning with 128.128.130. You can choose any three digits between 0 and 255 as the last three digits for the IP address.

Click 'OK', and you will get a message that these settings will be effective when the card is used the next time. Click 'OK' now, and you will return to the 'Network Cards' menu.

4 Access PC Wi-Fi Connections

Now, on your PC or laptop, click the 'Wireless Connections' icon in the system tray. Alternatively, you can access it from **Start > My Network Places > View Network Connections**.

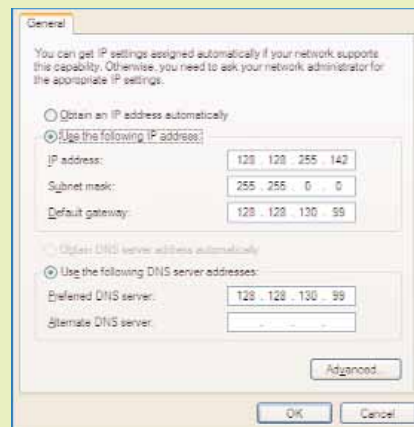
5 Edit Network Properties

Right-click your wireless network connection icon, and click 'Properties'. In the list of protocols installed, scroll down and select 'Internet Protocol (TCP/IP)', and click 'Properties'.

6 Enter The IP Address

Once you reach the Properties dialog box, select 'Use the following IP address' to specify an IP address. You need to be careful and provide an IP address of the same series as that on your PDA. Continuing with our example, let's provide the following:

IP Address: 128.128.255.142
Subnet Mask: 255.255.0.0
Default Gateway: 128.128.130.99
DNS Server: 128.128.130.99



The TCP/IP properties

7 Configure Wireless Network

On the top of the window, click the 'Wireless Networks' tab. Make sure the tab, 'Use Windows to configure my wireless network settings' is checked.

Click the 'Add' button, and provide an SSID (Secure Set Identification) for the PC or the laptop as the case maybe.

Uncheck 'Data encryption (WEP enabled)', and then click 'OK'.

When you come to the wireless connections window, you will see the SSID with an icon with a red cross on it.

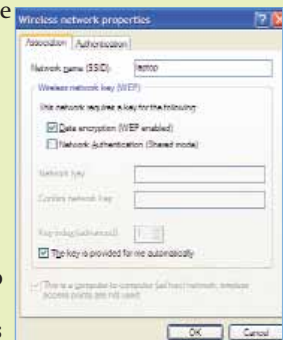
There's no cause for concern as this simply implies that the wireless connection or the PDA is not in range yet. This is because the Wi-Fi access on the PDA hasn't been activated so far.

8 Connecting To Your PC

Start your Wi-Fi connection, and you will find your PDA scanning for a network.

Click **Tools > Network Cards** to view the available networks. Select 'laptop' or whatever SSID you gave the PC or laptop, and select 'OK'. You'll now see that the PDA has connected to the PC or laptop.

At this point, you will be able to browse shared folders on your desktop PC or laptop.



Uncheck the 'Data Protection (WEP enabled)' option



Search And Connect Your Network

varun_dubey@thinkdigit.com